

Riverside Food Bank — Minutes of the Board of Trustees

Meeting held on 24 February 2026 at 18:30, Riverside Community Hall

Present: Anika Sorensen (Chair), Joaquin Herrera (Treasurer), Grace Mbeki, Rafael Quintero, Aiko Tanabe. In attendance: Chinonso Eze (Operations Manager).

1. Apologies and declarations of interest

Apologies from Hye-jin Park. No new declarations of interest.

2. Minutes of the previous meeting

The minutes of 25 November 2025 were approved and signed by the Chair.

3. Matters arising

The van insurance has been renewed. The volunteer handbook update is still outstanding (carried forward).

4. Operations update

Chinonso reported that 1,940 food parcels were distributed in December and January, 23% more than a year earlier. Fresh food donations from two supermarkets have started. Storage is at capacity on Saturdays.

5. Finance

Joaquin presented the management accounts to 31 January. Unrestricted reserves stand at four months of running costs, within policy. The board approved the draft budget for 2026–27.

6. Resolutions

1. To lease additional storage space at the industrial estate for up to 6,000 per year.
2. To apply to the Exampleton Community Fund for a part-time volunteer coordinator.

7. Any other business

Grace will represent the food bank at the council's anti-poverty forum on 12 March.

8. Date of next meeting

26 May 2026 at 18:30. The meeting closed at 20:10.